

REPORT

2026 Global Crypto Adoption Index: World's Crypto Economy Held Firm Through the Bear Market

September 23, 2026 | Chainalysis Team

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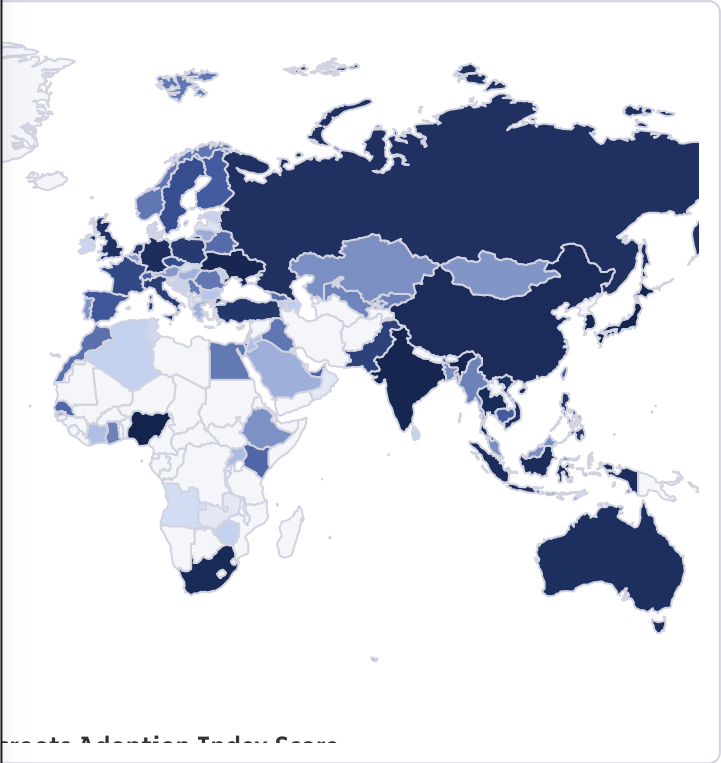
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Big Money Adoption Index



the 2026 Chainalysis Global Crypto Adoption Index.

- **Crypto economy overcame worst market since 2022:** Even as crypto's total market cap fell about 50% (a \$2.1 trillion contraction), on-chain economic activity slipped just 1.6%, from \$9.5 trillion to \$9.4 trillion. A growing diversity of use cases, not price speculation, kept the economy steady.
- **A new methodology reframes how we measure adoption:** This seventh edition of the report ranks countries across four factors: service flows, domestic peer-to-peer activity, cross-border flows, and on-chain balances. Measured this way, grassroots adoption proved resilient worldwide, with emerging markets leading the way.
- **Brazil ranked as the world's top country for grassroots crypto adoption:** At \$252.5 billion, Latin America's largest crypto economy placed in the top four worldwide across every factor the index tracks: second in cross-border flows, third in total service flows, third in its domestic peer-to-peer economy, and fourth in on-chain balances.

The 2026 Geography of Crypto Report



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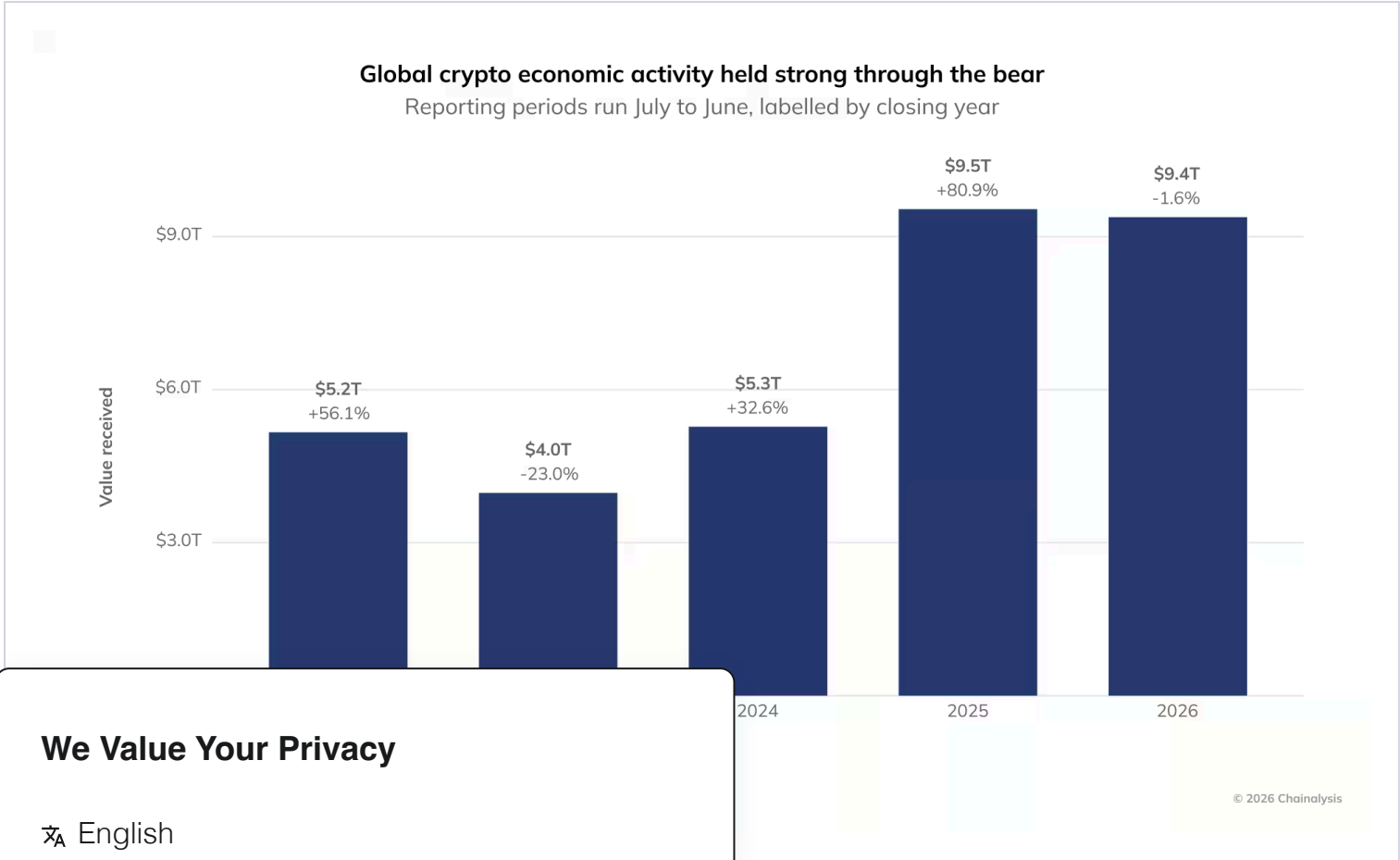
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tless identities. For capital allocators in the d reshape the way assets trade. For low-stablecoins help them move value quickly tainty. For everyday people, everywhere,

at one of the most extreme stretches for and June 30, 2026, (the period this report high and then recorded its largest-ever o trough. The overall crypto market cap's ned the worst crypto bear market since the

prior period. (You can read more about our methodology in determining the crypto economy at the end of this chapter). This metric, which combines many of the factors that drive our adoption index, shows \$9.4 trillion in economic activity for the 12 months ending June 30, 2026, compared to \$9.5 trillion in the 12 months ending June 30, 2025.



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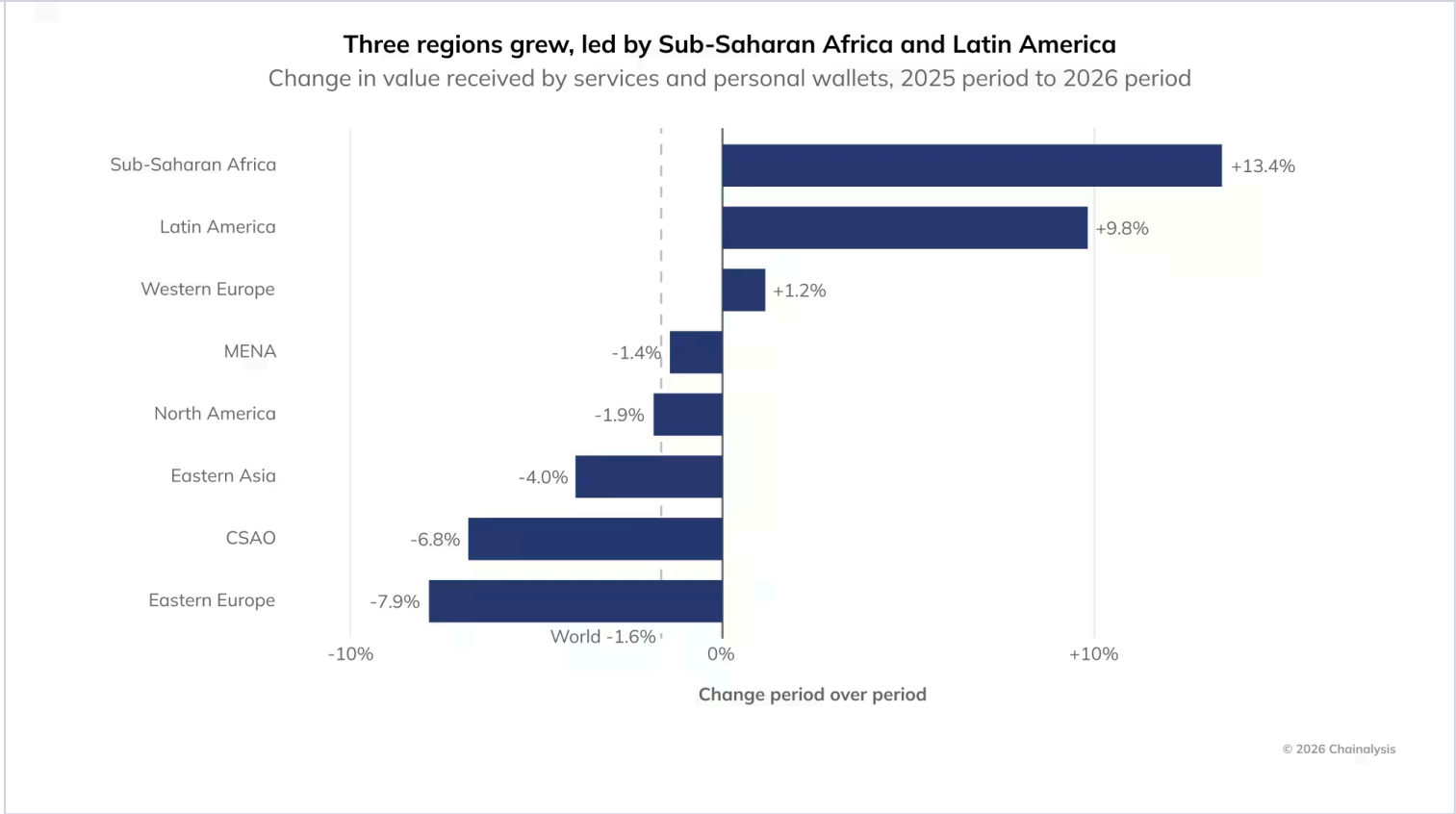
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market half as valuable as it used to be. If crypto were only being used as an investment, the market's lower prices might have reduced its value. That time saw a bigger drop as well in pure dollar terms (\$1.2 trillion vs \$0.1 trillion) and overall crypto market cap (-\$0.3 trillion vs

the contraction.

These identities are shaping crypto adoption and use, using data and on-the-ground insights, particularly in emerging economies. In the next chapter, on Latin America, we'll see the global trend, growing its crypto economy. We'll also see a collective pivot to stablecoins and the use of cryptocurrencies as a hedge against currency volatility. In a later chapter, we discuss how



We’re also rethinking how we measure adoption. Our seventh annual edition of the *Global Crypto Adoption Index* for tracking adoption. It weighs service adoption, cross-border crypto flows, and the volume of crypto held in wallets. The end of this chapter explains the

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Small businesses saw the sharpest

growth in the services people use to buy, sell, trade, and move this large portion of the economy to crypto. In the 2026 period, we found that small-businesses of under \$100 rose 78.4%, and transfers participation is only one small contributor to the total. Just \$273 billion of nearly \$10 trillion in crypto persisted through the bear market.



Institutional-sized transfers also proved relatively resilient amid the pullback in prices. Transfers of \$1 million or more dropped just 7.2% period over period. This is a notably small drawdown given how severely prices dropped. The crypto they had was worth, in the worst cases, 50% less than it used to be. As we pointed out before, you have to move as valuable to get where you were before. This challenge, keeping the drawdown in

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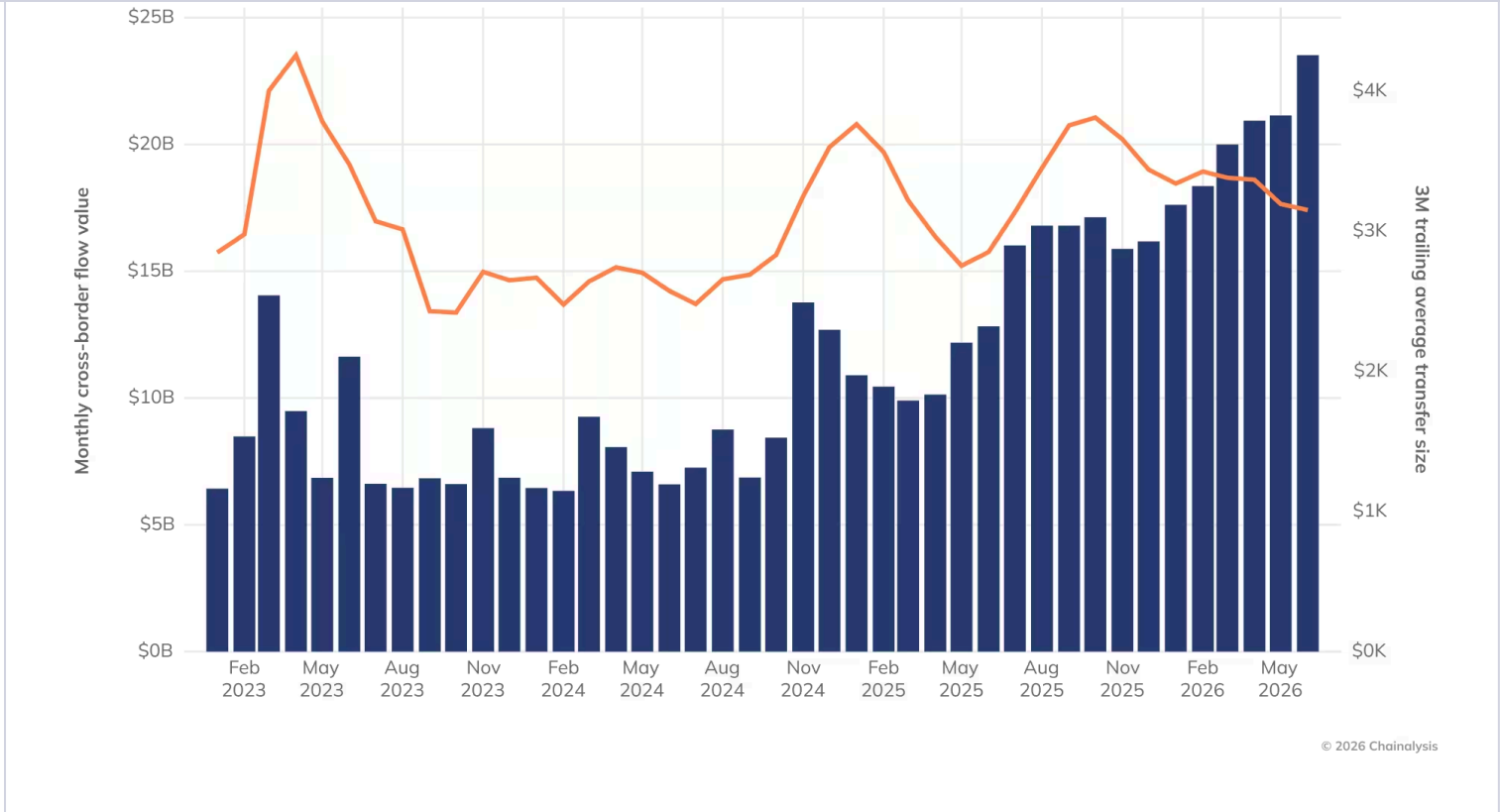
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Transfers boomed

GENIUS Act in the U.S., MiCA in the EU, and U.K., are driving stablecoin adoption. Our stablecoin value more than doubled from 2026, with actual volumes likely much 77.5% over the period, from \$124.2 billion

s that average about \$3,000: a transaction aligns with everyday use cases: a person ing savings out of a currency they no

wallets in a steady rhythm rather than in mics at Tether, told us. “That is the signature of trade and business activity, not speculation.”



All cross-border flows have an origin and an end point, forming what trade economists call “corridors.” The top quartile of corridors accounts for 96.1% of cross-border stablecoin

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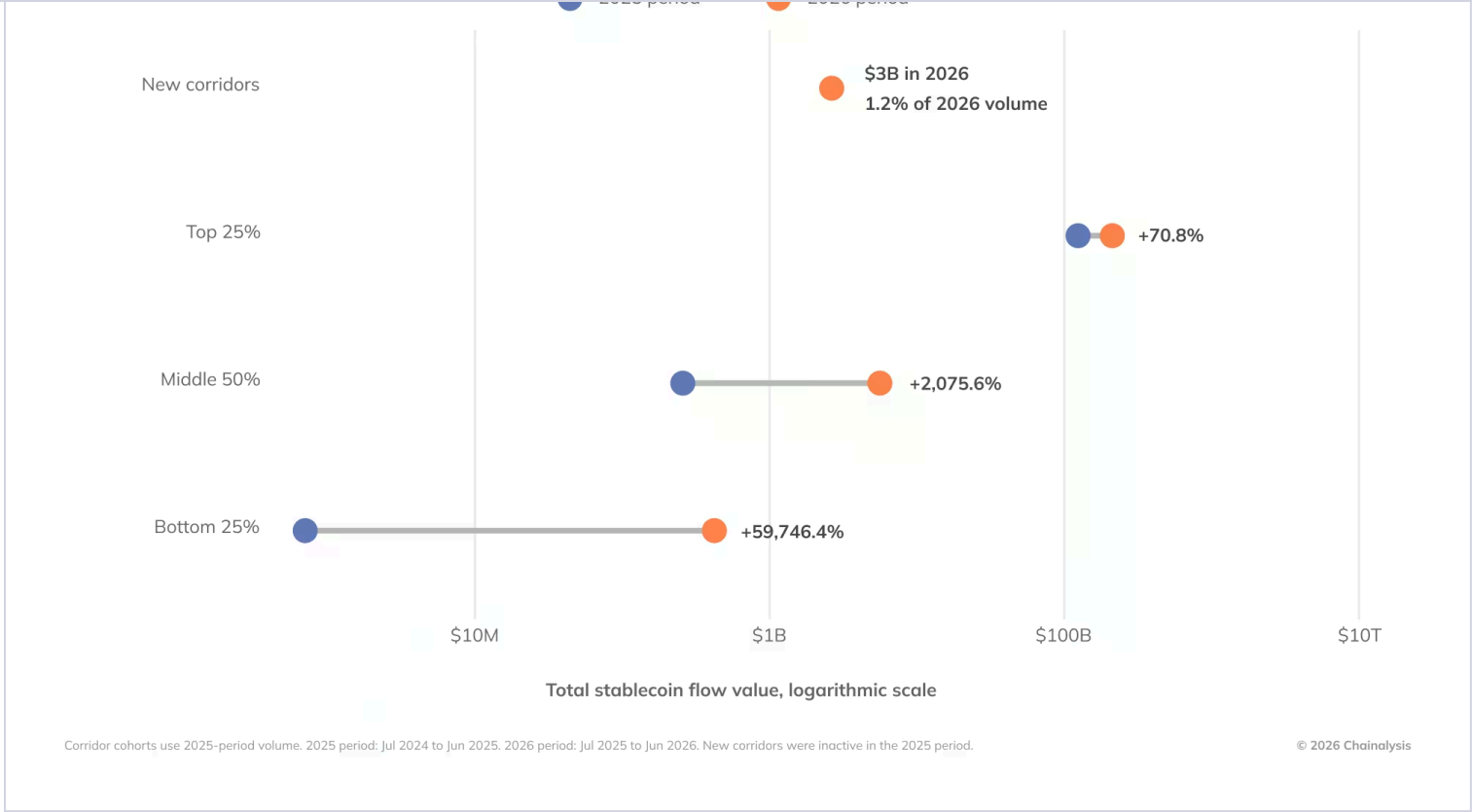
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they boost flows across once quiet
ree quartiles of corridors saw just \$0.26
w corridors opened rapidly. We tracked
umulatively carried \$2.64 billion. Much of this
SDT.

arts of the economy that were priced out
ogy was too expensive or too restricted,”
t costs on average one cent per
more than a phone.”



Our cross-border measure counts only transfers where we can attribute both the sending and receiving wallets we cannot place, or routed through unidentifiable wallets. The actual volume of stablecoin value transferred is more than \$220.3 billion.

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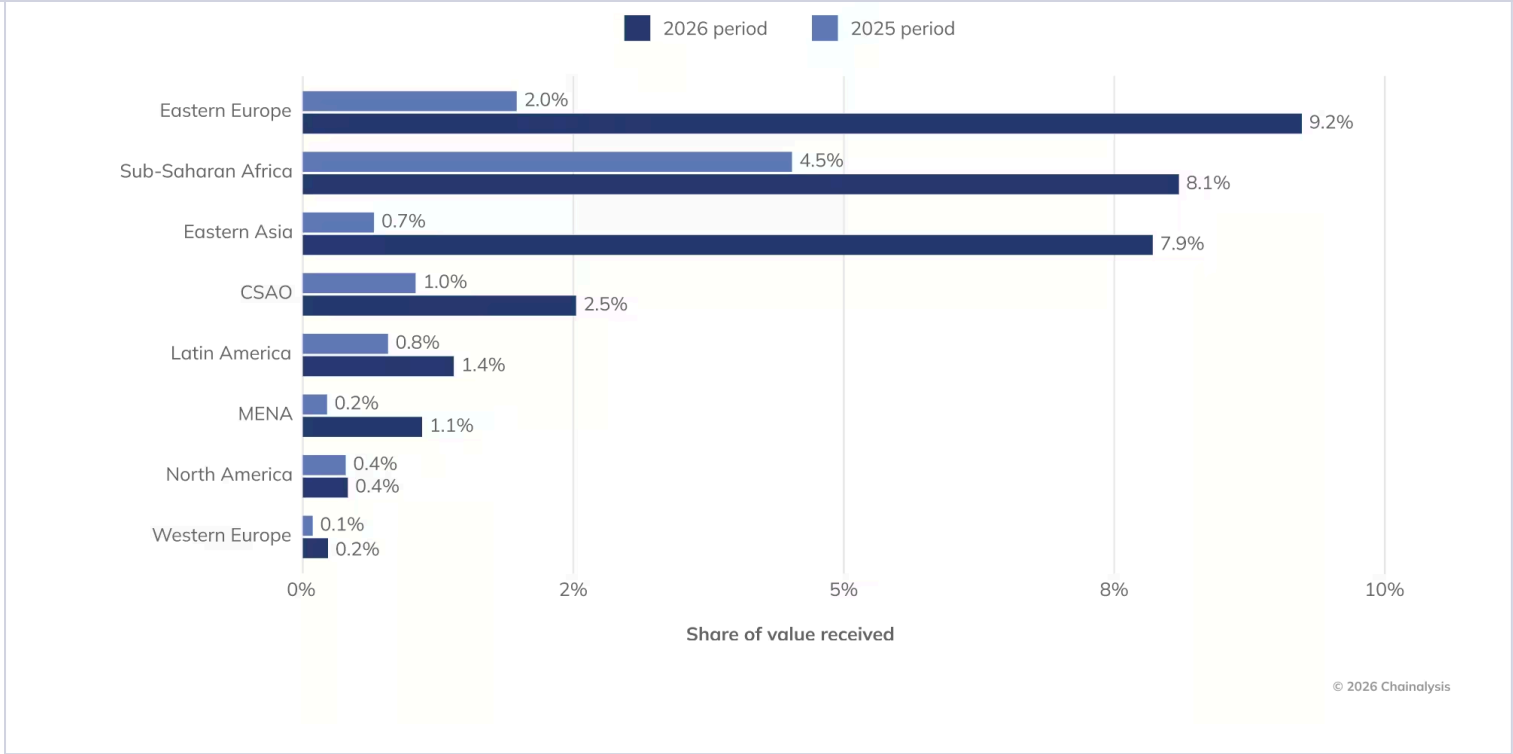
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the world

Peer activity did not. Value flowing into wallets fell 4.3%, from \$9.30 trillion to \$8.90 trillion. Value flowing into wallets inside countries rose 302.9%, from \$1.1 trillion to \$4.4 trillion. That's up from 0.6% of the two combined to 2.5%,



Most of what arrives at a service is a trade or an on-ramp, and both track price. When the market halves, the same trade carries half the dollars, and speculative turnover falls with sentiment on top of that. A stablecoin payment does neither. It is denominated in dollars, it happens whether the market is rising or

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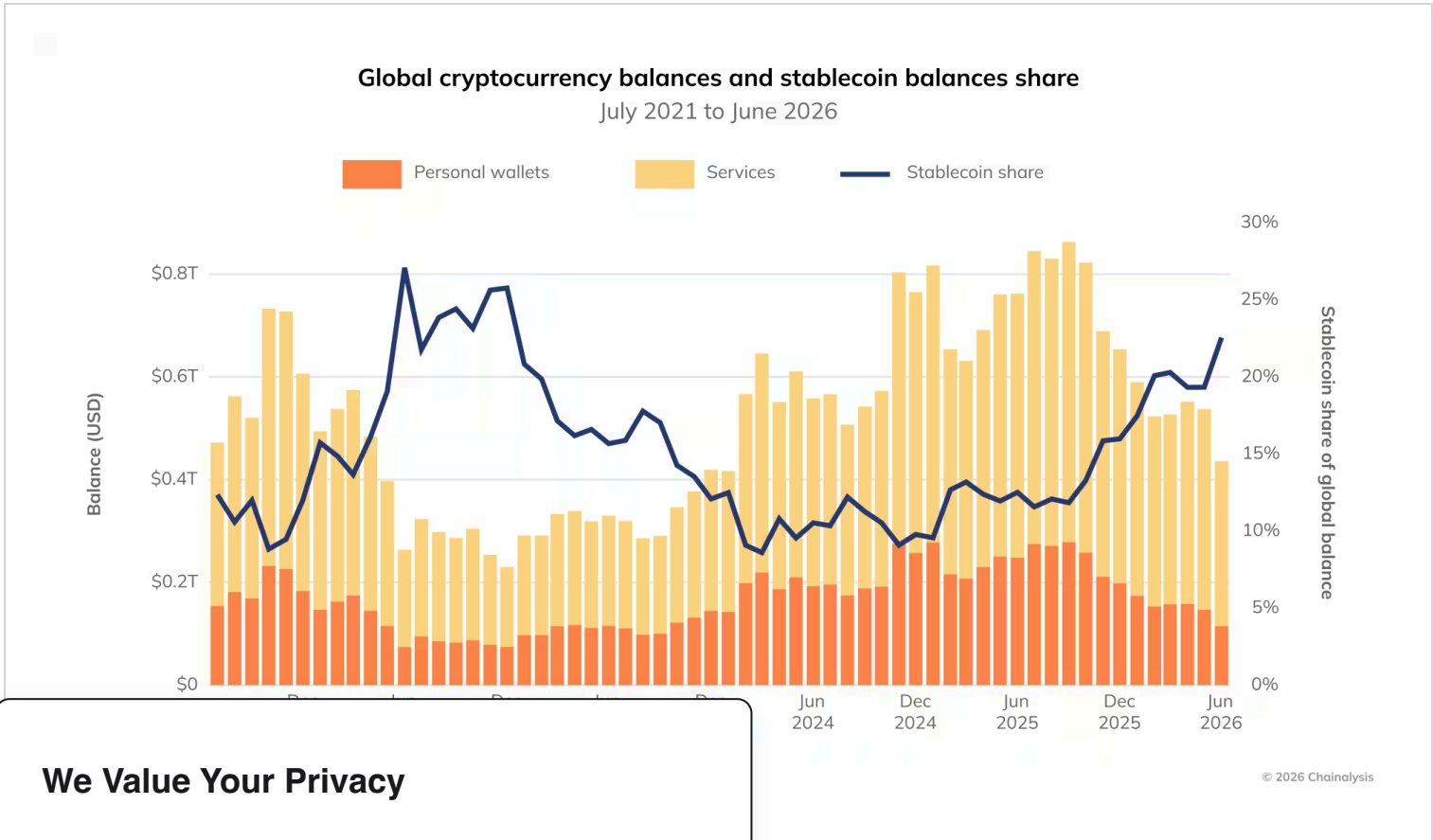
as between them. Service inflows in
ws fell. Domestic peer-to-peer across all
e 377.7%. What separates the two
peer is now 96% stablecoins, services are
of crypto and left the payments half alone.

hor through the

o held in wallets and on services at a point
d balances fell from a September 2025
6.

nd \$109 billion across the nine-month
the dollar, their on-chain value does not
55.6%. Their share of global balances

This pattern is not new: stablecoin balances grew 72.5% between December 2022 and September 2025, then held their level through the 2026 drawdown. Each cycle starts from a higher stablecoin base than the last, and stablecoins' share of total balances rises whenever the broader market drops.



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per, region- and country-level analysis of
ws, wallet balances, in-country economies,
any identities of crypto.

r crypto adoption

ds the world in grassroots crypto adoption.
ve track. However, in a year when bear
livered strong performance relative to its
United States. We will extensively discuss
xt chapter: Latin America.

assroots adoption

Balances ranking	P2P economy	Cross border
---------------------	----------------	-----------------

United States of America	2	1	1	20	11
Nigeria	3	18	18	1	1
Japan	4	4	7	10	4
Republic of Korea	5	5	2	12	12
India	6	2	3	16	16
Ukraine	7	8	8	6	6
Thailand	8	25	6	5	8
South Africa	9	33	16	4	3
Canada	10	15	9	7	7
Mexico	11	21	13	8	5
			15	2	14
			5	15	15
			12	13	10
			10	11	9
			21	9	19
			11	24	24
			23	14	17
			14	22	21
			19	17	20

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Service flows: Value received by centralized exchanges, DeFi protocols, and other crypto services, weighted by a country's GDP per capita.

- **Domestic peer-to-peer transfers:** Value moving directly between personal wallets inside the same country.
- **Cross-border transfers:** Value crossing a national border, covering four routes: person to person, person to service, service to person, and business to business.
- **Balances:** Holdings at a point in time, combining geolocatable personal wallets with the balances held on select service types, including exchanges, no KYC exchanges and peer to peer exchanges.

We rank the 117 countries for which we have sufficient data. To do this, we first weight the raw values by each country's purchasing power parity and then rescale every country onto a common 0-to-1 scale by min-max normalization, placing the lowest-ranked country at 0 and the highest at 1.

A country's overall index score is the geometric mean of its four normalized scores. This method rewards countries that perform consistently across all four measures and prevents dominance in a single category from masking weakness elsewhere. For our grass roots index, our rank 1 country, Brazil, for example, does not rank number one on any individual measure, making it the overall rank

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Proportionality to a country

Proportionality to a country is a set of moral indicators, such as interactions with a service, that are harder to measure. It's more difficult: an exchange pools every country's transactions, so the blockchain alone cannot tell us a transaction's value across countries in proportion to the country it came from. The same allocation

Proportionality typically represents a larger transaction value. We give more weight each country's traffic share by the square root to normalize. Using the square root, rather than the square, so wealth influences the split without being too large. The total is unchanged; only its distribution across countries is changed by a country's wealth level.

(\$3.78 billion). The 3.7x gap between them is the square root of the gap in GDP per capita, \$36,239 against \$2,695. The exchange's total is unchanged: the adjustment moves value between countries rather than creating it.

We acknowledge that web traffic data are imperfect. A best effort has been made to clear out VPNs and bot traffic, but this process can be imperfect. In the end, our index accounts for hundreds of millions of cryptocurrency transactions and more than 13 billion web visits. We also compare findings with insights from local crypto experts and operators around the world, giving us more confidence in this methodology.

What time period our index covers

Our index covers 12 month periods running from July 1 to June 30 of the following year. Periods are labeled by the year in which they close. The 2026 period covers July 1, 2025 to June 30, 2026. Likewise, the 2025 period covers July 1, 2024 to June 30, 2025.

Definitions

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and with a country by calculating its on-chain activity. We thought of as a measure somewhere in the middle of (what's bought and sold locally) and financial activity (the index). Practically, the all-in economy

services, including centralized exchanges, decentralized exchanges, lending protocols, and bridges. Activity is measured by the service, estimated from web traffic, and is incorporated. Values are adjusted for GDP per capita.

ing between personal wallets within the same size. Bitcoin counts below \$10,000. We exclude domestic peer-to-peer activity and avoids activity between counterparties and change addresses. Value arriving from abroad in a resident's wallet or a service paid it out. Stablecoins count below \$10,000. We cut bitcoin off at this level

Stablecoins move for payment, savings and settlement at every size, so we impose no cap. Bitcoin at large sizes behaves differently, and including it without a limit would let treasury and trading movements dominate a measure built to capture how people use crypto.

We attribute each transfer to the place it lands. Transfers from personal wallets into services, and between services, are not added on top. They already arrive at a service, so they sit inside the first category, and counting them a second time would inflate the total.

This matters when comparing our figures with others. A measure that sums inflows and outflows, or that counts a transfer at both ends, will produce a larger number for the same underlying activity.

Our estimate is a lower bound

Our measurement of the on-chain economy very likely underestimates the true total; the crypto economy in every market is larger than what we report. We designed our metric conservatively in order to achieve greater precision. We filter out activity in two ways:

1. Excluding unclustered service noise: Outside the service layer, only stablecoins and smaller Bitcoin transfers count. Ethereum, other tokens, and larger Bitcoin transfers are economic activity but are not in the total.
2. Excluding unattributed transfers: Transfers we cannot confidently attribute to a service are not in the total.

Chainalysis began coverage in July 2022. Therefore the reporting period onward. Earlier years reflect

Crypto



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